U.S. Citizenship Family Study Guide

PREPARING FOR 2027

Civics • English • Interview practice

Prepared for Richmond and family | Pennsylvania edition

Research checked: November 12, 2026

Start with the right test. Under the rules checked for this guide, people who file Form N-400 on or after October 20, 2025 take the **2025 civics test**, including applicants filing in 2027. It has a 128-question study bank. The test name is its version, not your interview year.

Included: all 128 civics questions with a short answer to practice; interview examples; English vocabulary and exercises; Pennsylvania answers; mock tests and a family study plan.

Use your own facts. Personal interview answers are practice examples, not facts about your family and not a script to repeat regardless of the truth.

Before the 2027 interview: recheck the test rules and every current-officeholder answer. Election winners and officials currently in office are not always the same people.

Print on US Letter paper at 100% or “Fit.” Black-and-white printing and double-sided printing are suitable. Copy the worksheets for each family member.

Independent study aid, not a USCIS publication or an individual eligibility determination. Official sources and update links are listed at the end.

How to use this guide

1. Read “Your test and interview” and identify any exception for each applicant.

2. Make a separate personal fact sheet for every family member. Review the exact N-400 that person submitted.

3. Learn the 128 civics questions aloud. Cover the example answers and have a partner ask questions in a different order.

4. Practice reading aloud and writing from dictation every day. Reading and writing are separate skills.

5. Use the interview examples to answer in simple, truthful English. Review all questions on your own N-400, including any not illustrated here.

6. Complete the mock tests, update the officeholder worksheet, and prepare the document folder.

Quick page finder

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What the labels mean

Example answer: a short answer to practice. For civics, this guide usually selects one accepted answer rather than printing every acceptable alternative.

***:** one of the 20 specially designated questions for qualifying 65/20 applicants. Everyone else should study all 128.

RECHECK: an answer that depends on the interview date or the applicant’s residence.

Listen for how many answers are required

“Name one” means give one. “Name two” means give two. The examples already supply the required number. For question 81, name five original states; for questions 65 and 126, give three items.

There are no multiple-choice options on the real oral civics test. Short correct answers are sufficient; you do not need to recite an essay.

Your test and interview

Part	What to practice / passing requirement
Application review and speaking	Answer questions about your N-400 and background. The officer evaluates your ability to understand and speak English during the interview, unless exempt.
Civics: 2025 version	Up to 20 oral questions from 128. Pass with 12 correct. The officer stops at 12 correct or 9 incorrect.
English reading	Read aloud 1 of up to 3 sentences correctly.
English writing	Write 1 of up to 3 dictated sentences correctly.

Which civics version applies?

N-400 filed **before October 20, 2025:** the 2008 test, 100 study questions, up to 10 asked, 6 correct to pass. This guide's 128-question bank is not a complete substitute for that older bank.

N-400 filed **on or after October 20, 2025:** the 2025 test described here, subject to any future USCIS change.

If you do not pass the first time

USCIS generally gives two attempts per application. A retest of the failed portion is normally scheduled 60-90 days after the first interview. Passing the tests alone does not establish eligibility or make you a citizen. [1, 2]

Exceptions for family members

Check each person's age and years as a lawful permanent resident **at filing**. Years simply living in the United States are not automatically years as a permanent resident.

Rule	What it means
50/20	Age 50 or older + 20 years as a permanent resident: English exemption; civics still required.
55/15	Age 55 or older + 15 years as a permanent resident: English exemption; civics still required.
65/20	Age 65 or older + 20 years as a permanent resident: English exemption plus special civics consideration. Study the 20 starred questions; 6 correct out of up to 10 asked.
Medical disability exception	A qualifying physical/developmental disability or mental impairment may support an English and/or civics exception using Form N-648. A qualified medical professional must complete it; approval is not automatic.

For an age/residence English exemption, civics may be taken in your native language. Bring an interpreter fluent in English and that language. Check USCIS interpreter requirements before the appointment. [3]

Disability accommodations, such as assistance for hearing or vision, are different from a testing exception. Request needed accommodations using USCIS instructions. Being older, having limited schooling, or finding English difficult does not by itself establish a medical exception.

The 20 special-study questions

2, 7, 12, 20, 30, 36, 38, 39, 44, 52, 61, 66, 74, 78, 86, 94, 113, 115, 121, 126. These are marked * in the bank below.

Before applying and before interview

For the usual five-year path, requirements generally include being at least 18, lawful permanent residence, five years of continuous residence, at least 30 months physically present during the relevant five years, and residence in the state or USCIS district for at least three months. Good moral character and other requirements also apply. Other paths have different rules. [4]

Some applicants may file up to 90 calendar days before completing the required residence period. This does not waive other eligibility requirements. Use the current N-400 instructions and USCIS filing calculator; do not assume that five years after first arriving in America is the correct date. [5]

Prepare one folder per person

• Read the exact submitted N-400 and any supporting statements. Identify mistakes and changes to discuss with the officer.

• Make an accurate travel list: departure date, return date, destination, and total time away, including trips since filing.

• Review home addresses, work/school history, marriages, children, and any applicable support obligations.

• Review tax records and any relevant court, immigration, or Selective Service records. Do not guess about an unresolved issue.

• Long absences, criminal history, false citizenship claims, voting issues, or missed required Selective Service registration may require individualized advice from an immigration attorney or DOJ-accredited representative.

This guide prepares you for the interview; it does not calculate anyone’s eligibility or replace the current application instructions.

Personal fact sheet - copy for each person

Fill from your records, not memory alone. Keep this page private. Do not write full Social Security or A-numbers on a shared study copy. The answers below are individual, so there is no shared family answer key.

Full legal name: _____

Other names used: _____

Date and country of birth: _____

Current home address: _____

Date you moved to this address:

_____

“Resident Since” date on green card:

_____

N-400 filing date and eligibility basis:

_____

Current job or school: _____

Marital status / spouse’s name, if applicable:

_____

Children / support details, if applicable:

_____

Last trip abroad: departure and return:

_____

Changes since filing: _____

Interview date, time and location:

_____

Interview practice: opening and identity

These are representative practice prompts, not an official fixed interview script. Replace bracketed text with your facts; use any yes/no answer only if true. An officer may phrase questions differently.

1. How are you today?

Example answer: I am well, thank you.

2. Why are you here today?

Example answer: I am here for my naturalization interview.

3. Do you promise to tell the truth?

Example answer: Yes, I do. [Only if you understand and agree.]

4. What is your full legal name?

Example answer: My full legal name is [full legal name].

5. Have you used any other names?

Example answer: Yes. I have also used [name]. / No, I have not. [Choose the truthful answer.]

6. What is your date of birth?

Example answer: I was born on [month, day, year].

7. Where were you born?

Example answer: I was born in [city, country].

8. Do you want to legally change your name?

Example answer: No, I do not. / Yes, I would like to change it to [name].

Interview practice: home, work and family

9. What is your current address?

Example answer: I live at [street address, city, state, ZIP code].

10. How long have you lived there?

Example answer: I have lived there since [month and year].

11. Where did you live before that?

Example answer: I lived at [previous address] from [date] to [date].

12. Where do you work or go to school?

Example answer: I work at [employer] as a [job]. / I am a student at [school]. / I am retired.

13. Are you married?

Example answer: Yes, I am married. / No, I am single. / I am divorced. [Use your actual legal status.]

14. What is your spouse’s name and citizenship?

Example answer: My spouse is [name] and is a citizen of [country]. [If applicable.]

15. Do you have children?

Example answer: Yes, I have [number] children. Their names are [names]. / No, I do not.

16. Have you met your child or spousal support obligations?

Example answer: Yes, I have, and I brought [records]. / I need to explain [facts]. / This does not apply to me. [Only if accurate.]

Interview practice: residence and travel

17. When did you become a permanent resident?

Example answer: I became a permanent resident on [date shown as Resident Since].

18. How did you obtain permanent residence?

Example answer: I became a permanent resident through [actual category, such as family sponsorship].

19. Have you traveled outside the United States during the period covered by your application?

Example answer: Yes. I took [number] trips. My travel list has the dates. / No, I have not.

20. Where did you go on your last trip?

Example answer: I went to [country] from [departure date] to [return date].

21. How long were you outside the United States?

Example answer: My last trip lasted [number] days. My total time abroad during the relevant period was [total].

22. Have you traveled since you filed your N-400?

Example answer: Yes. I visited [country] from [date] to [date]. / No, I have not.

23. Has anything else changed since you applied?

Example answer: Yes, I changed [address/job/marital status] on [date]. / No, nothing has changed.

24. Is there an error in your application?

Example answer: Yes. I need to correct [item]. The correct information is [fact]. / I have not found an error.

Interview practice: eligibility and conduct

Read the full questions on your submitted N-400. A question using “ever” is not limited to the last five years. Do not assume an arrest can be omitted because charges were dismissed or a record was sealed. Follow the current form instructions.

25. Have you ever claimed to be a U.S. citizen?

Example answer: No, I have not. / Yes. It happened [when and how]. [Answer truthfully; obtain individual advice for a yes.]

26. Have you ever registered to vote or voted in an election in the United States?

Example answer: No, I have not. / Yes. Here are the facts: [details]. Do not use a memorized “no.”

27. Do you owe overdue federal, state or local taxes?

Example answer: No. / Yes, I owe [amount], and [explain the accurate status or payment arrangement].

28. Have you ever failed to file a tax return when required?

Example answer: No. / Yes, for [year]. Here is what happened and what I have done [facts].

29. Have you ever been arrested, cited or detained by law enforcement?

Example answer: No. / Yes. On [date], in [place], I was [arrested/cited/detained]. The outcome was [outcome].

30. Have you ever been charged with or convicted of an offense?

Example answer: No. / Yes. The charge was [charge] and the outcome was [disposition]. I brought the relevant records.

Interview practice: background follow-ups

31. Have you ever committed an offense for which you were not arrested?

Example answer: No. / Yes. I need to explain [truthful details].

32. Have you ever given false information to obtain an immigration benefit?

Example answer: No. / Yes. The circumstances were [facts].

33. Have you ever been in removal or deportation proceedings?

Example answer: No. / Yes. The proceeding was [details and outcome].

34. What organizations or groups have you belonged to?

Example answer: I have belonged to [names and purpose, as applicable]. / I have no memberships to report under that question.

35. Have you ever served in a military, police unit or armed group?

Example answer: No. / Yes. I served in [organization] from [date] to [date], and my duties were [duties].

36. Have you ever persecuted anyone or participated in serious abuse or violence?

Example answer: No. / Yes. I need to explain the facts. [Listen to each specific question; do not give one blanket answer.]

37. Did you register for Selective Service, if required?

Example answer: Yes. My registration information is [record]. / I did not register; here are the facts and relevant documents. / I was not required because [accurate reason].

Interview practice: oath and understanding

These are separate commitments. Do not answer “yes” just to pass if you do not understand or cannot sincerely agree. Explain any religious or conscientious objection; lawful oath modifications may be available. [5]

38. Do you support the Constitution and form of government of the United States?

Example answer: Yes, I do. [If true.]

39. Do you understand the Oath of Allegiance?

Example answer: Yes. It includes loyalty to the United States and support for its Constitution and laws. [If understood.]

40. Are you willing to take the full Oath of Allegiance?

Example answer: Yes, I am. / I need to discuss an oath modification because [truthful reason].

41. Are you willing to bear arms on behalf of the United States when required by law?

Example answer: Yes, I am. / I have a religious or conscientious objection that I need to explain.

42. Are you willing to perform noncombatant service in the U.S. armed forces when required by law?

Example answer: Yes, I am. / I need to explain my objection.

43. Are you willing to perform work of national importance under civilian direction when required by law?

Example answer: Yes, I am. / I need to explain my position.

44. Why do you want to become a U.S. citizen?

Example answer: I want to participate fully in my community and vote. [An optional personal example; use your real reason.]

Useful English for the interview

If you did not hear the question

Example answer: Could you please repeat the question?

If you need simpler wording

Example answer: Could you please rephrase that?

If you do not understand a word

Example answer: I do not understand that word. Could you explain it?

If you cannot remember an exact date

Example answer: I do not remember the exact date. May I check my records?

If you need to correct yourself

Example answer: I am sorry. I need to correct my answer. The correct answer is [fact].

Listen and follow directions

“Please stand.” - Stand up.

“Raise your right hand.” - Raise your right hand.

“Please have a seat.” - Sit down.

“Show me your green card.” - Present it.

“Read this sentence aloud.” - Read the words shown; do not simply answer a written question.

“Write this sentence.” - Listen and write the words dictated.

“Sign here.” - Sign where directed, after understanding what you are signing.

These phrases help communication, but they do not replace the English requirement. Practice understanding questions in several wordings.

N-400 vocabulary in plain English

This is a comprehension aid, not a separate official vocabulary-definition exam. Read each word in the context of the actual application question.

Word or phrase	Plain-English meaning
Legal name / other names	Your name in legal records / other names you have used.
Residence / physical presence	Where you live / time actually spent in the United States.
Marital status	Whether you are single, married, divorced, widowed, or legally separated.
Dependent / support	Someone who depends on you / money or care you are responsible for providing.
Owe / overdue	Have an unpaid obligation / payment is past its due date.
Arrested / detained	Taken into custody / held by an authority.
Cited / charged / convicted	Given an official citation / formally accused / found guilty or entered a plea resulting in conviction. These are different events.
False testimony / fraud	Untrue statements under oath / deception to obtain a benefit.
Persecute	Mistreat someone because of characteristics or beliefs such as religion or political opinion.
Oath / allegiance	A solemn promise / loyalty.
Bear arms / noncombatant	Carry or use weapons in military service / military service without combat duties.

English reading vocabulary

Practice recognizing and saying these words. They follow the categories in the USCIS reading vocabulary resource. Recheck the current official list before your interview. [6]

People

Abraham Lincoln; George Washington

Civics

American flag; Bill of Rights; capital; citizen; city; Congress; country; Father of Our Country; government; President; right; Senators; state; states; White House

Places

America; United States; U.S.

Holidays

Presidents’ Day; Memorial Day; Flag Day; Independence Day; Labor Day; Columbus Day; Thanksgiving

Question words

How; What; When; Where; Who; Why

Verbs

can; come; do; does; elects; have; has; is; are; was; be; lives; lived; meet; name; pay; vote; want

Small words

a; for; here; in; of; on; the; to; we

Other words

colors; dollar bill; first; largest; many; most; north; one; people; second; south

English writing vocabulary

Say each word, cover it, write it, and check the spelling. These categories follow the USCIS writing vocabulary resource. [6]

People and places

Adams; Lincoln; Washington; Alaska; California; Canada; Delaware; Mexico; New York City; United States; Washington, D.C.

Civics

American Indians; capital; citizens; Civil War; Congress; Father of Our Country; flag; free; freedom of speech; President; right; Senators; state; states; White House

Months

February; May; June; July; September; October; November

Holidays

Presidents' Day; Memorial Day; Flag Day; Independence Day; Labor Day; Columbus Day; Thanksgiving

Verbs

can; come; elect; have; has; is; was; be; lives; lived; meets; pay; vote; want

Small words

and; during; for; here; in; of; on; the; to; we

Other words

blue; dollar bill; fifty / 50; first; largest; most; north; one; one hundred / 100; people; red; second; south; taxes; white

Reading and dictation practice

These are **created practice sentences**, not a released list of actual test sentences. Read the left column aloud. A partner then reads the right column while you write it without looking. The right column is also the answer key. On the real reading test, read the displayed sentence instead of answering it.

Read aloud	Dictate / correct written answer
Who was the first President?	Washington was the first President.
Where does the President live?	The President lives in the White House.
What is the capital of the United States?	Washington, D.C. is the capital of the United States.
Who elects Congress?	Citizens elect Congress.
How many Senators do we have?	We have one hundred Senators.
When is Independence Day?	Independence Day is in July.
When is Presidents’ Day?	Presidents’ Day is in February.
When is Memorial Day?	Memorial Day is in May.
When is Flag Day?	Flag Day is in June.
When is Labor Day?	Labor Day is in September.
When is Columbus Day?	Columbus Day is in October.
When is Thanksgiving?	Thanksgiving is in November.

More English practice and writing space

Read aloud	Dictate / correct written answer
What are the colors of the American flag?	The flag is red, white, and blue.
What is the largest state?	Alaska is the largest state.
What state has the most people?	California has the most people.
Who was the Father of Our Country?	Washington was the Father of Our Country.
Who lived here first?	American Indians lived here first.
Why do people come to America?	People come here to be free.

Write from dictation

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

Partner: compare the written words to the exact sentence you dictated. Practice complete sentences and readable writing. Do not assume every small spelling or punctuation error automatically means failure; USCIS applies its scoring rules.

Pennsylvania and changing answers

Snapshot checked November 12, 2026 - not guaranteed for 2027. Use the person actually serving on your interview date. Recheck after January 2027 transitions and again just before your interview. If you move to another state, replace the Pennsylvania answers. [7-10]

Question / office	Practice answer as of this guide
23. One Pennsylvania U.S. senator	John Fetterman. David McCormick is another acceptable Pennsylvania answer.
29. Your U.S. representative	Depends on your home address. Example only: Scott Perry for Pennsylvania's 10th District as of this snapshot. Recheck for 2027; do not memorize this example as a future answer.
30. Speaker of the House	Mike Johnson. RECHECK.
38. President	Donald Trump. RECHECK.
39. Vice president	JD Vance. RECHECK.
57. Chief Justice	John Roberts. RECHECK.
61. Pennsylvania governor	Josh Shapiro. RECHECK.
62. Pennsylvania capital	Harrisburg.

Find your representative by entering your own address at **house.gov/representatives/find-your-representative**. A ZIP code can cross district lines. Your U.S. representative is not your state representative, mayor, or senator.

Update worksheet for the interview date

Complete this page separately for each address in the family. Do not use “president-elect,” “governor-elect,” or a projected winner unless that person has actually taken office.

Interview date: _____

State of residence: _____

Congressional district: _____

One current U.S. senator:

_____

Current U.S. representative:

_____

Current Speaker of the House:

_____

Current president: _____

Current vice president: _____

Current Chief Justice: _____

Current governor: _____

State capital: _____

Date answers were verified:

_____

Where to verify

Federal test updates: **uscis.gov/citizenship/testupdates**
Senators: **senate.gov/senators**
Representative: **house.gov/representatives/find-your-representative**
Pennsylvania governor: **pa.gov/governor**

Civics: the complete 128-question bank

The following pages preserve the official question numbering and give a short model response for **every question**. Most answers are one selected acceptable answer; questions requesting several items have the required number.

Question text is from USCIS M-1778 (09/25), the 2025-version question bank. This guide is reformatted for family study. Current-officeholder examples and Pennsylvania answers are added separately and marked for rechecking. [11]

A simple way to study

• Read the question and answer together once. Explain the meaning in your own words.

• Cover the answer. Say it aloud without reading.

• Ask a partner to change the question order. Mark questions you miss.

• Review missed questions the following day and again a week later.

• Aim for at least 18 correct on repeated 20-question practice rounds. The official passing requirement remains 12.

A few useful connections

Congress: writes laws; Senate + House.
President: executive branch; signs or vetoes bills.
Courts: judicial branch; review and explain laws.
1776: Declaration of Independence.
1787: Constitution written.
27: constitutional amendments.
100 / 435: senators / voting House members.

Civics questions 1-8

1. What is the form of government of the United States?

Example answer: Republic

2. What is the supreme law of the land? *

Example answer: The U.S. Constitution.

3. Name one thing the U.S. Constitution does.

Example answer: Protects the rights of the people.

4. The U.S. Constitution starts with the words “We the People.” What does “We the People” mean?

Example answer: People should govern themselves.

5. How are changes made to the U.S. Constitution?

Example answer: Amendments

6. What does the Bill of Rights protect?

Example answer: The basic rights of people living in the United States.

7. How many amendments does the U.S. Constitution have? *

Example answer: Twenty-seven (27)

8. Why is the Declaration of Independence important?

Example answer: It says America is free from British control.

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 9-16

9. What founding document said the American colonies were free from Britain?

Example answer: Declaration of Independence

10. Name two important ideas from the Declaration of Independence and the U.S. Constitution.

Example answer: Equality and liberty.

11. The words “Life, Liberty, and the pursuit of Happiness” are in what founding document?

Example answer: Declaration of Independence

12. What is the economic system of the United States? *

Example answer: Capitalism

13. What is the rule of law?

Example answer: Everyone must follow the law.

14. Many documents influenced the U.S. Constitution. Name one.

Example answer: Declaration of Independence

15. There are three branches of government. Why?

Example answer: So one part does not become too powerful

16. Name the three branches of government.

Example answer: Legislative, executive, and judicial.

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 17-24

17. The President of the United States is in charge of which branch of government?

Example answer: Executive branch

18. What part of the federal government writes laws?

Example answer: Congress.

19. What are the two parts of the U.S. Congress?

Example answer: The Senate and the House of Representatives.

20. Name one power of the U.S. Congress. *

Example answer: Writes laws

21. How many U.S. senators are there?

Example answer: One hundred (100)

22. How long is a term for a U.S. senator?

Example answer: Six (6) years

23. Who is one of your state's U.S. senators now?

Example answer: Pennsylvania example: John Fetterman. RECHECK for your state and interview date.

24. How many voting members are in the House of Representatives?

Example answer: 435.

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 25-32

25. How long is a term for a member of the House of Representatives?

Example answer: Two (2) years

26. Why do U.S. representatives serve shorter terms than U.S. senators?

Example answer: To more closely follow public opinion

27. How many senators does each state have?

Example answer: Two (2)

28. Why does each state have two senators?

Example answer: Equal representation for small states.

29. Name your U.S. representative.

Example answer: Address-dependent example: Scott Perry, for Pennsylvania's 10th District as of November 12, 2026. RECHECK your address and the officeholder for 2027.

30. What is the name of the Speaker of the House of Representatives now? *

Example answer: Mike Johnson. RECHECK before your interview.

31. Who does a U.S. senator represent?

Example answer: People of their state.

32. Who elects U.S. senators?

Example answer: Citizens from their state

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 33-40

33. Who does a member of the House of Representatives represent?

Example answer: People in their congressional district.

34. Who elects members of the House of Representatives?

Example answer: Citizens from their congressional district.

35. Some states have more representatives than other states. Why?

Example answer: Because of the state’s population.

36. The President of the United States is elected for how many years? *

Example answer: Four (4) years

37. The President of the United States can serve only two terms. Why?

Example answer: Because of the 22nd Amendment.

38. What is the name of the President of the United States now? *

Example answer: Donald Trump. RECHECK before your interview.

39. What is the name of the Vice President of the United States now? *

Example answer: JD Vance. RECHECK before your interview.

40. If the president can no longer serve, who becomes president?

Example answer: The vice president.

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 41-48

41. Name one power of the president.

Example answer: Signs bills into law

42. Who is Commander in Chief of the U.S. military?

Example answer: The president.

43. Who signs bills to become laws?

Example answer: The president.

44. Who vetoes bills? *

Example answer: The president.

45. Who appoints federal judges?

Example answer: The president.

46. The executive branch has many parts. Name one.

Example answer: The Cabinet.

47. What does the President's Cabinet do?

Example answer: Advises the president.

48. What are two Cabinet-level positions?

Example answer: Secretary of State and Secretary of the Treasury.

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 49-56

49. Why is the Electoral College important?

Example answer: It decides who is elected president.

50. What is one part of the judicial branch?

Example answer: Supreme Court

51. What does the judicial branch do?

Example answer: Reviews laws

52. What is the highest court in the United States? *

Example answer: Supreme Court

53. How many seats are on the Supreme Court?

Example answer: Nine (9)

54. How many Supreme Court justices are usually needed to decide a case?

Example answer: Five (5)

55. How long do Supreme Court justices serve?

Example answer: For life.

56. Supreme Court justices serve for life. Why?

Example answer: To be independent of politics.

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 57-64

57. Who is the Chief Justice of the United States now?

Example answer: John Roberts. RECHECK before your interview.

58. Name one power that is only for the federal government.

Example answer: Print paper money

59. Name one power that is only for the states.

Example answer: Provide schooling and education

60. What is the purpose of the 10th Amendment?

Example answer: Powers not given to the federal government belong to the states or to the people.

61. Who is the governor of your state now? *

Example answer: Pennsylvania example: Josh Shapiro. RECHECK for your state and interview date.

62. What is the capital of your state?

Example answer: Pennsylvania: Harrisburg. Use your own state's capital.

63. There are four amendments to the U.S. Constitution about who can vote. Describe one of them.

Example answer: Citizens eighteen and older can vote.

64. Who can vote in federal elections, run for federal office, and serve on a jury in the United States?

Example answer: U.S. citizens.

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 65-72

65. What are three rights of everyone living in the United States?

Example answer: Freedom of speech, freedom of religion, and freedom of assembly.

66. What do we show loyalty to when we say the Pledge of Allegiance? *

Example answer: The United States

67. Name two promises that new citizens make in the Oath of Allegiance.

Example answer: Defend the U.S. Constitution and obey the laws of the United States.

68. How can people become United States citizens?

Example answer: Naturalize.

69. What are two examples of civic participation in the United States?

Example answer: Vote and join a community group.

70. What is one way Americans can serve their country?

Example answer: Vote

71. Why is it important to pay federal taxes?

Example answer: Required by law

72. It is important for all men age 18 through 25 to register for the Selective Service. Name one reason why.

Example answer: Required by law

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 73-80

73. The colonists came to America for many reasons. Name one.

Example answer: Freedom

74. Who lived in America before the Europeans arrived? *

Example answer: Native Americans.

75. What group of people was taken and sold as slaves?

Example answer: Africans

76. What war did the Americans fight to win independence from Britain?

Example answer: The American Revolutionary War.

77. Name one reason why the Americans declared independence from Britain.

Example answer: High taxes

78. Who wrote the Declaration of Independence? *

Example answer: Thomas Jefferson.

79. When was the Declaration of Independence adopted?

Example answer: July 4, 1776

80. The American Revolution had many important events. Name one.

Example answer: The Declaration of Independence.

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 81-88

81. There were 13 original states. Name five.

Example answer: Pennsylvania, New York, New Jersey, Delaware, and Maryland.

82. What founding document was written in 1787?

Example answer: The U.S. Constitution.

83. The Federalist Papers supported the passage of the U.S. Constitution. Name one of the writers.

Example answer: James Madison.

84. Why were the Federalist Papers important?

Example answer: They helped people understand the (U.S.) Constitution.

85. Benjamin Franklin is famous for many things. Name one.

Example answer: Inventor.

86. George Washington is famous for many things. Name one. *

Example answer: First president of the United States.

87. Thomas Jefferson is famous for many things. Name one.

Example answer: Writer of the Declaration of Independence

88. James Madison is famous for many things. Name one.

Example answer: Father of the Constitution.

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 89-96

89. Alexander Hamilton is famous for many things. Name one.

Example answer: First Secretary of the Treasury

90. What territory did the United States buy from France in 1803?

Example answer: Louisiana Territory

91. Name one war fought by the United States in the 1800s.

Example answer: War of 1812

92. Name the U.S. war between the North and the South.

Example answer: The Civil War

93. The Civil War had many important events. Name one.

Example answer: The Battle of Gettysburg.

94. Abraham Lincoln is famous for many things. Name one. *

Example answer: 16th president of the United States.

95. What did the Emancipation Proclamation do?

Example answer: Freed slaves in the Confederate states.

96. What U.S. war ended slavery?

Example answer: The Civil War

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 97-104

97. What amendment says all persons born or naturalized in the United States, and subject to the jurisdiction thereof, are U.S. citizens?

Example answer: 14th Amendment

98. When did all men get the right to vote?

Example answer: With the 15th Amendment, in 1870.

99. Name one leader of the women's rights movement in the 1800s.

Example answer: Susan B. Anthony

100. Name one war fought by the United States in the 1900s.

Example answer: World War I

101. Why did the United States enter World War I?

Example answer: Because Germany attacked U.S. (civilian) ships

102. When did all women get the right to vote?

Example answer: With the 19th Amendment, in 1920.

103. What was the Great Depression?

Example answer: Longest economic recession in modern history

104. When did the Great Depression start?

Example answer: The stock market crash of 1929.

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 105-112

105. Who was president during the Great Depression and World War II?

Example answer: Franklin Roosevelt.

106. Why did the United States enter World War II?

Example answer: Japanese attacked Pearl Harbor.

107. Dwight Eisenhower is famous for many things. Name one.

Example answer: General during World War II

108. Who was the United States' main rival during the Cold War?

Example answer: Soviet Union

109. During the Cold War, what was one main concern of the United States?

Example answer: Communism

110. Why did the United States enter the Korean War?

Example answer: To stop the spread of communism

111. Why did the United States enter the Vietnam War?

Example answer: To stop the spread of communism

112. What did the civil rights movement do?

Example answer: Fought to end racial discrimination

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 113-120

113. Martin Luther King, Jr. is famous for many things. Name one. *

Example answer: Fought for civil rights.

114. Why did the United States enter the Persian Gulf War?

Example answer: To force the Iraqi military from Kuwait

115. What major event happened on September 11, 2001 in the United States? *

Example answer: Terrorists attacked the United States.

116. Name one U.S. military conflict after the September 11, 2001 attacks.

Example answer: War in Afghanistan.

117. Name one American Indian tribe in the United States.

Example answer: Cherokee.

118. Name one example of an American innovation.

Example answer: Airplane.

119. What is the capital of the United States?

Example answer: Washington, D.C.

120. Where is the Statue of Liberty?

Example answer: New York Harbor.

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Civics questions 121-128

121. Why does the flag have 13 stripes? *

Example answer: Because there were 13 original colonies.

122. Why does the flag have 50 stars?

Example answer: Because there is one star for each state.

123. What is the name of the national anthem?

Example answer: The Star-Spangled Banner

124. The Nation's first motto was "E Pluribus Unum." What does that mean?

Example answer: Out of many, one

125. What is Independence Day?

Example answer: A holiday to celebrate U.S. independence from Britain.

126. Name three national U.S. holidays. *

Example answer: Independence Day, Thanksgiving Day, and Christmas Day.

127. What is Memorial Day?

Example answer: A holiday to honor soldiers who died in military service

128. What is Veterans Day?

Example answer: A holiday to honor people who have served in the U.S. military.

* = special 65/20 study question. RECHECK = date- or address-dependent.

Mock interview: family role-play

One person is the officer and one is the applicant. Put study notes away. This is practice, not a prediction of the exact order used by USCIS.

1. Opening

Ask the applicant to stand, raise the right hand, and promise to tell the truth. Model response: “Yes, I do.”

2. Identity and application

Ask their legal name, birth date, address, work/school, marital status, residence date and recent travel. Compare answers to their personal records, not another family member’s answers.

3. Background and updates

Choose several conduct and oath questions from this guide and the submitted N-400. The correct response is the truthful personal answer. Ask what changed since filing.

4. Reading

Show up to three practice sentences, one at a time. Stop when one is read correctly.

5. Writing

Dictate up to three sentences, one at a time. Do not let the applicant copy them. Stop when one is written correctly.

6. Civics

Use a mock test on the following pages. Stop at 12 correct or 9 incorrect. A family member should check answers using the bank. Other official acceptable answers also count.

7. Review

Discuss mistakes kindly. Repeat missed items on another day. Practice without coaching before the applicant answers.

Civics mock test A - questions only

1. [Q2] What is the supreme law of the land?

2. [Q10] Name two important ideas from the Declaration of Independence and the U.S. Constitution.

3. [Q16] Name the three branches of government.

4. [Q21] How many U.S. senators are there?

5. [Q24] How many voting members are in the House of Representatives?

6. [Q28] Why does each state have two senators?

7. [Q36] The President of the United States is elected for how many years?

8. [Q40] If the president can no longer serve, who becomes president?

9. [Q48] What are two Cabinet-level positions?

10. [Q52] What is the highest court in the United States?

11. [Q60] What is the purpose of the 10th Amendment?

12. [Q65] What are three rights of everyone living in the United States?

13. [Q71] Why is it important to pay federal taxes?

14. [Q78] Who wrote the Declaration of Independence?

15. [Q81] There were 13 original states. Name five.

16. [Q92] Name the U.S. war between the North and the South.

17. [Q102] When did all women get the right to vote?

18. [Q113] Martin Luther King, Jr. is famous for many things. Name one.

19. [Q121] Why does the flag have 13 stripes?

20. [Q126] Name three national U.S. holidays.

Score: _____ correct / _____ asked. Stop at 12 correct or 9 incorrect.
For extra learning, review unasked questions after the scored test.

Civics mock test B - questions only

1. [Q1] What is the form of government of the United States?

2. [Q4] The U.S. Constitution starts with the words “We the People.” What does “We the People” mean?

3. [Q7] How many amendments does the U.S. Constitution have?

4. [Q13] What is the rule of law?

5. [Q19] What are the two parts of the U.S. Congress?

6. [Q23] Who is one of your state’s U.S. senators now?

7. [Q29] Name your U.S. representative.

8. [Q30] What is the name of the Speaker of the House of Representatives now?

9. [Q38] What is the name of the President of the United States now?

10. [Q39] What is the name of the Vice President of the United States now?

11. [Q49] Why is the Electoral College important?

12. [Q57] Who is the Chief Justice of the United States now?

13. [Q61] Who is the governor of your state now?

14. [Q62] What is the capital of your state?

15. [Q67] Name two promises that new citizens make in the Oath of Allegiance.

16. [Q79] When was the Declaration of Independence adopted?

17. [Q95] What did the Emancipation Proclamation do?

18. [Q105] Who was president during the Great Depression and World War II?

19. [Q115] What major event happened on September 11, 2001 in the United States?

20. [Q128] What is Veterans Day?

Score: _____ correct / _____ asked. Stop at 12 correct or 9 incorrect.
Before scoring changing answers, check the officials serving on the practice date.

Mock test A - answer key

These match the selected answers in the bank. Other USCIS-accepted answers may also be correct. For every RECHECK item, use the answer valid for the applicant's state, district and interview date.

1. **[Q2]** The U.S. Constitution.
2. **[Q10]** Equality and liberty.
3. **[Q16]** Legislative, executive, and judicial.
4. **[Q21]** One hundred (100)
5. **[Q24]** 435.
6. **[Q28]** Equal representation for small states.
7. **[Q36]** Four (4) years
8. **[Q40]** The vice president.
9. **[Q48]** Secretary of State and Secretary of the Treasury.
10. **[Q52]** Supreme Court
11. **[Q60]** Powers not given to the federal government belong to the states or to the people.
12. **[Q65]** Freedom of speech, freedom of religion, and freedom of assembly.
13. **[Q71]** Required by law
14. **[Q78]** Thomas Jefferson.
15. **[Q81]** Pennsylvania, New York, New Jersey, Delaware, and Maryland.
16. **[Q92]** The Civil War
17. **[Q102]** With the 19th Amendment, in 1920.
18. **[Q113]** Fought for civil rights.
19. **[Q121]** Because there were 13 original colonies.
20. **[Q126]** Independence Day, Thanksgiving Day, and Christmas Day.

Mock test B - answer key

1. [Q1] Republic

2. [Q4] People should govern themselves.

3. [Q7] Twenty-seven (27)

4. [Q13] Everyone must follow the law.

5. [Q19] The Senate and the House of Representatives.

6. [Q23] Pennsylvania example: John Fetterman. RECHECK for your state and interview date.

7. [Q29] Address-dependent example: Scott Perry, for Pennsylvania's 10th District as of November 12, 2026. RECHECK your address and the officeholder for 2027.

8. [Q30] Mike Johnson. RECHECK before your interview.

9. [Q38] Donald Trump. RECHECK before your interview.

10. [Q39] JD Vance. RECHECK before your interview.

11. [Q49] It decides who is elected president.

12. [Q57] John Roberts. RECHECK before your interview.

13. [Q61] Pennsylvania example: Josh Shapiro. RECHECK for your state and interview date.

14. [Q62] Pennsylvania: Harrisburg. Use your own state's capital.

15. [Q67] Defend the U.S. Constitution and obey the laws of the United States.

16. [Q79] July 4, 1776

17. [Q95] Freed slaves in the Confederate states.

18. [Q105] Franklin Roosevelt.

19. [Q115] Terrorists attacked the United States.

20. [Q128] A holiday to honor people who have served in the U.S. military.

Eight-week family study plan

Week	Focus
1	Read the test rules; complete personal fact sheets; learn civics 1-16.
2	Learn civics 17-32; practice address, work and family interview questions.
3	Learn civics 33-48; practice reading and writing daily.
4	Learn civics 49-64; review travel and residence records; verify Pennsylvania answers.
5	Learn civics 65-80; practice conduct questions using each person’s true history.
6	Learn civics 81-96; review oath questions and difficult English words.
7	Learn civics 97-112; do mixed review of all earlier questions.
8	Learn civics 113-128; take mock tests; prepare the interview folder.

A 25-minute daily session

10 minutes: new and missed civics questions.
5 minutes: older questions in random order.
5 minutes: reading aloud and sentence dictation.
5 minutes: personal interview practice.

After week 8, continue mixed review several times a week until the interview. Let each person progress at their own pace. Choose a different family member to act as officer each session.

Weekly check-in

Questions to repeat: _____
Words to practice: _____
Personal records to confirm: _____

Interview-day checklist

Follow your own appointment notice and current N-400 instructions. Requirements vary by case. This list is a preparation aid, not an instruction to bring every item regardless of relevance. [5, 12]

• [ ] Interview appointment notice.

• [ ] Permanent Resident Card (green card).

• [ ] State-issued photo identification, such as a driver’s license.

• [ ] All valid and expired passports and travel documents documenting absences since becoming a permanent resident.

• [ ] Copy of your submitted N-400, supporting statements, and a list of corrections or changes.

• [ ] Originals or certified records relevant to your case: marriage/divorce/name-change records, court dispositions, tax/payment records, support records, and Selective Service documentation when applicable.

• [ ] Any extra documents specifically requested by USCIS.

• [ ] Interpreter if permitted/required for your qualifying exception; any approved accommodation arrangements.

• [ ] Plan transportation, parking and arrival according to the notice. Bring needed glasses or hearing aids.

Do not guess at an answer to hide uncertainty. Ask for clarification, explain accurately, and correct mistakes. Never submit a false statement just because it matches a practice answer.

After the interview and oath ceremony

The officer gives you the examination result, commonly on Form N-652. Your case may be granted, continued for further evidence or testing, or denied. A passed test does not automatically mean the application is approved. [1, 12]

If USCIS asks for more information

Read the written request carefully. Provide the requested evidence by the stated deadline and keep a copy. If a test portion must be repeated, study that portion and follow the new appointment notice.

If approved

Follow the oath-ceremony notice. Complete any required updates truthfully, including travel or other changes after the interview. Bring the documents named in the notice and your green card as directed.

You generally become a U.S. citizen when you take the Oath of Allegiance at the naturalization ceremony. A passed interview alone does not make you a citizen. [12]

After naturalization

Check the naturalization certificate for errors before leaving. Keep it safe. Use official instructions to apply for a U.S. passport, update relevant records, and register to vote if eligible. Do not register or vote as a U.S. citizen before becoming one.

Final family reminder

Know your own application. Understand each question. Give the number of civics answers requested. Recheck current officials. Speak clearly, and tell the truth.

Official sources and update links

Rules and online source information checked November 12, 2026. No guide written now can guarantee the rules or officeholders for a future interview. The links below are clickable and also printed for later use.

1. USCIS: The Naturalization Interview and Test

https://www.uscis.gov/citizenship/learn-about-citizenship/the-naturalization-interview-and-test

2. USCIS Policy Manual: English and Civics Testing

https://www.uscis.gov/policy-manual/volume-12-part-e-chapter-2

3. USCIS: Exceptions and Accommodations

https://www.uscis.gov/citizenship/exceptions-and-accommodations

4. USCIS: Naturalization eligibility / permanent residents

https://www.uscis.gov/citizenship/learn-about-citizenship/citizenship-and-naturalization/i-am-a-lawful-permanent-resident-of-5-years

5. USCIS: Form N-400 and current instructions

https://www.uscis.gov/n-400

6. USCIS: Study for the Test (English vocabulary resources)

https://www.uscis.gov/citizenship/find-study-materials-and-resources/study-for-the-test

7. USCIS: Civics Test Updates

https://www.uscis.gov/citizenship/testupdates

8. U.S. Senate: Pennsylvania senators

https://www.senate.gov/states/PA/intro.htm

9. U.S. House: find your representative

https://www.house.gov/representatives/find-your-representative

10. Pennsylvania: Governor

https://www.pa.gov/governor

11. USCIS: 128 Civics Questions and Answers (M-1778)

https://www.uscis.gov/sites/default/files/document/questions-and-answers/2025-Civics-Test-128-Questions-and-Answers.pdf

12. USCIS: Citizenship - What to Expect

https://my.uscis.gov/citizenship/what_to_expect

Source notes and practice record

Civics question text and selected answers come from the U.S. government's 2025-version M-1778 booklet. Because direct USCIS PDF access was blocked during preparation, the document was retrieved from this public mirror:

https://www.immi-usa.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/09/2025-Civics-Test-128-Questions-and-Answers.pdf

The test-version and scoring rules were cross-checked against USCIS's indexed guidance and USAGov. The current-official examples were checked against USCIS test updates, Senate, House and Pennsylvania government pages. USCIS remains the controlling source for test administration.

https://www.usa.gov/naturalization

The personal interview prompts, plain-English explanations, English practice sentences, mock-test selections and study plan were created for this guide. They are not an official prediction of the questions an officer will ask. The guide does not reproduce every individual N-400 question or every possible eligibility issue.

Practice log - photocopy as needed

Date	Civics score	Reading / writing	Review next
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

Ready check: [ ] Full bank studied [ ] Personal application reviewed
[ ] Repeated mock passes [ ] Officials rechecked [ ] Documents prepared